FAMILY AND FRIENDS 2 · GRAMMAR EXPLAINED

Unit 3 · I can ride a bike!

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

can tells what we are able to do. It never changes. After can the verb is plain. Words like in, on, under, behind tell where things are.

Can значит «уметь / мочь». Оно не меняется. После can глагол простой. Слова in, on, under, behind говорят, где стоят предметы.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
+	subject · can · verb	**I can skate.**	Я умею кататься.
No	subject · can't · verb	**She can't swim.**	Она не умеет плавать.
Question	Can · subject · verb?	**Can she play tennis?**	Она умеет играть в теннис?
Answer	Yes, she can. / No, she can't.	**Yes, she can.**	Да.
Where?	in · on · under · behind · in front of · next to	**The ball is behind the chair.**	Мяч за стулом.

When we use it

Say what you can do: I can ride a bike.
Сказать, что умеешь.

Say where a thing is: The cat is under the table.
Сказать, где предмет.

REMEMBER

can + plain verb. Same form for I, you, he, she, it, we, they.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

По-русски «Он умеет плавать». По-английски: He can swim (без -s и без «to»).

Watch out! We often say...

~~He cans swim.~~	**He can swim.**
~~I can to skate.~~	**I can skate.**
~~Does she can play?~~	**Can she play?**

EASY TRICK

can is the same for everybody: I can · he can (no -s!). No «to» after can.

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 I ___ swim. (can / cans)

2 She can ___ tennis. (play / plays)

3 ___ he skate? (Can / Does)

4 He ___ ride a bike. (can't / don't)

5 The ball is ___ the chair. (behind / for)

6 The cat is ___ the box. (in / at)

Answers: 1 can · 2 play · 3 Can · 4 can't · 5 behind · 6 in